



Android N supports VR

Android N will have more extensive support for Virtual reality.
<http://dgit.in/ANVRL>



Road-legal race car

Aston Martin has launched a limited edition called the Vantage GT8 which is absolutely road legal. <http://dgit.in/legalraceA>

Bazaar

Samsung Gear VR

Prepare to look stupid in public

Kicking things off with the build and design of the headset, it's made mostly of plastic and it feels sturdy. There is a mesh of rubber and Velcro which ensures a tight structure around the eyes and comfort as well. The headband has Velcro straps that can be adjusted easily. So if you are one with a big head or a small one, fear not, the headset will fit you. The only con with the headset is the housing where you put the smartphone. The cover that you need to remove feels very cheap and it's the first thing you will lose.

There is a USB port on the Gear VR headset and a touchpad along with the back button rests on the right side. There is a volume rocker on the right too. There is a focus wheel on the top and if you move the focus wheel, you can physically see the smartphone move close and far from the lens.

Another reason why the flap housing the smartphone is flimsy is because if you want to see what's happening in the real world, you can use the smartphones camera to do that. For this you will need to remove the flap. For the audio experience, you'd be wise to use a pair of headphones for a more immersive experience. A good thing about the headset is that it is comfortable even for those with glasses.

Setting up the Gear VR is a breeze. Put your smartphone in the housing, wear the headset and wait for the Oculus app to download. We recommend you remove the headset and go through the app on your phone to download games and apps. It's easier to search for apps and skip pages and type names of the apps you are looking for. This is something you can't do from the comfort of the headset and is major drawback.

The battery life of the device is subject to not only use but the Samsung phone you are using it with. On an average it consumes 20% of your smartphones battery in one hour. We tested the headset with the Galaxy Note 5.

Another downside to consuming content in VR is that you have absolutely no idea what's happening around you. The number of times I've hit my hand to my desk while watching Netflix in VR is a lot! Sticking with the cons, some content looks pixilated at times and despite my efforts to get the image to focus completely, it always seems a little out of focus.

There is another problem while watching movies (we tried this on the Netflix app). When you



change your position, the position of the screen doesn't change. So if you are sitting and watching a movie in VR and you want to lie down or move, the position of the video doesn't adjust to you and that's a big bummer.

But it's not all bad! There are a bunch of things that you will absolutely love on the headset.

For example, there is an animated movie called Invasion that you can check out and it's just the tip of the iceberg for the potential that VR content has. This 5 minute movie shows you a cute and cuddly rabbit who is in the middle of an alien invasion. It was an absolute delight to watch.

Gaming is another area where the Gear VR was a lot of fun. Classic games like Into the Dead and Temple Run which have VR variants are a clear indicator of the level of immersion VR brings to the table. To put things simply, it's the same difference you will face when playing Dance Central with a controller versus playing the game with the Kinect.

Playing a dog fighting game on the VR headset was incredibly fun and there is a game called Samsung School of Rugby that will make you go round and round in one spot, literally.

There is one thing I'm happy to say though. There is a lot of content available for consumption the moment you get your hands on the Gear VR, unlike 1080p, 4K and 3D which suffered from a lack of content at the time of their launch.

Sameer Mitha



Features	80
Performance	75
Design	70
Value	50

Specifications

Compatible with: Galaxy S6, S6 Edge, S6 Edge Plus, S7, S7 Edge, and Note 5 only; **Weight:** 318 grams; **Field of View:** 96-degrees; **UI/Buttons:** Touchpad, Back key, Volume Key, Focus adjustment wheel; **Sensors:** Gyro, Accelerometer, Proximity

Contact

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